

Scenario:

Customer tries to transfer ₹50,000.

Transaction failed.

Error shown: "Transaction could not be completed."

Expected discoveries:

1. Daily limit exceeded
2. Insufficient balance
3. Bank server unavailable
4. OTP expired
5. Network timeout
6. Beneficiary inactive
7. Fraud rule triggered
8. Core banking unavailable
9. UPI switch unavailable

Chain of Thought prompt are as follows:

Act as a finance expert and identify the root cause of this below scenario. Also provide step by steps to understand the transaction failure

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From a finance and payments perspective, the UI message "**Transaction could not be completed.**" is only a generic customer-facing error. It does **not** identify the real cause. The actual root cause is typically determined by tracing the transaction through the payment flow and checking the response from each participating system.

Transaction Flow

Customer Initiates Transfer



Authentication (OTP)

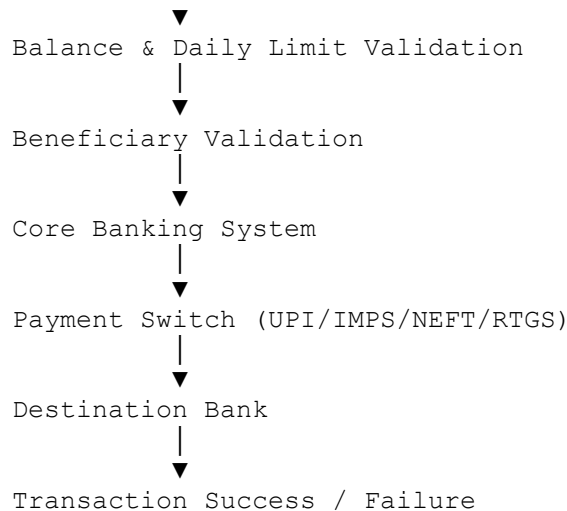


Channel (Mobile/Web App)



Fraud & Risk Engine





Step-by-Step Root Cause Analysis

Step 1: Check Transaction Details

Verify:

- Transaction ID
- Customer ID
- Source account
- Beneficiary account
- Transfer amount (₹50,000)
- Date and time
- Payment type (UPI/IMPS/NEFT/RTGS)

Purpose: Ensures you are investigating the correct transaction.

Step 2: Verify Daily Transfer Limit

Question:

Has the customer already reached the permitted daily transfer limit?

Example:

Daily limit = ₹1,00,000

Already transferred = ₹60,000

Current transfer = ₹50,000

Total = ₹1,10,000

Result:

Daily Limit Exceeded

Root Cause

Business Validation Failure

Step 3: Check Available Balance

Verify

Available Balance

-

Lien Amount

-

Minimum Balance Requirement

-

Charges

Example

Balance = ₹48,000

Transfer = ₹50,000

Result

Insufficient Balance

Step 4: Verify OTP

Check

- OTP generation time
- OTP expiry time
- Number of attempts

- Whether OTP was validated successfully

Example

OTP valid for

120 seconds

Customer entered after

180 seconds

Result

OTP Expired

Step 5: Check Beneficiary Status

Verify

- Beneficiary Active?
- Blocked?
- Deleted?
- Cooling period completed?

Example

Beneficiary Status = INACTIVE

Result

Beneficiary Inactive

Step 6: Check Fraud Rules

Fraud engine verifies

- Large amount
- Unusual location
- New device
- Velocity checks
- Blacklisted beneficiary
- AML rules

Example

Risk Score = 98

Threshold = 80

Result

Fraud Rule Triggered

Step 7: Verify Core Banking

Check

- CBS availability
- Account lookup
- Debit request
- Debit confirmation

Possible failures

Connection timeout

Service unavailable

Maintenance

Result

Core Banking Unavailable

Step 8: Verify Payment Switch

Depending on payment type

UPI

IMPS

NEFT

RTGS

Check

- Request sent?
- Response received?
- Timeout?

- Gateway unavailable?

Possible Result

UPI Switch Unavailable

or

Network Timeout

Step 9: Verify Destination Bank

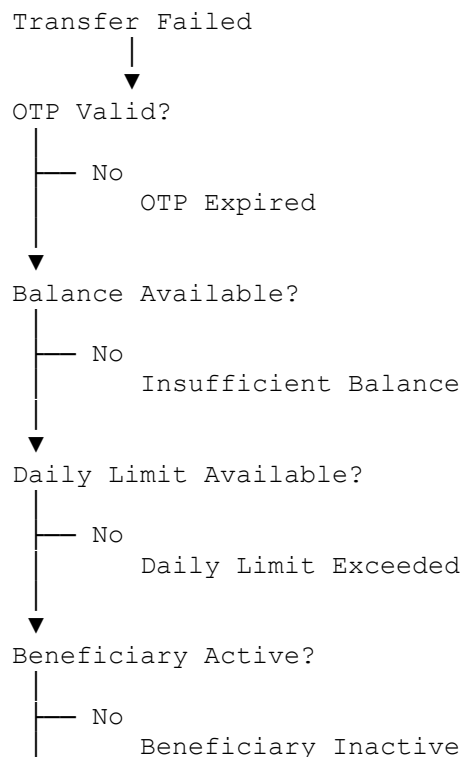
Check

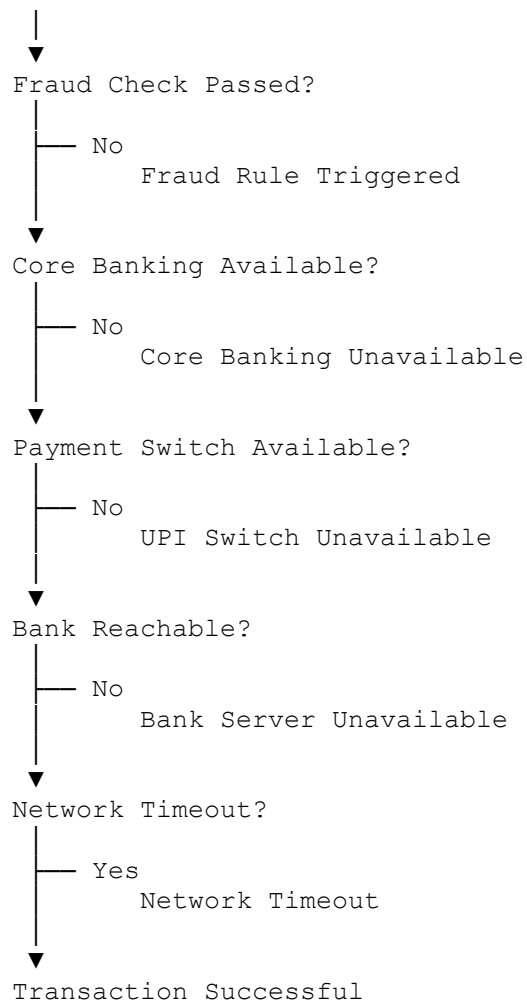
- Bank online?
- Bank maintenance?
- Bank accepted debit?

Possible response

Bank Server Unavailable

Decision Tree





Root Cause Matrix

Possible Cause	Where to Investigate	Evidence
Daily limit exceeded	Business rules / limit service	Daily transfer total exceeds configured limit
Insufficient balance	Core banking / account service	Available balance lower than required amount
Bank server unavailable	Destination bank integration	5xx errors, connection failures, maintenance
OTP expired	Authentication service	OTP expired before validation
Network timeout	API gateway / network logs	Request timed out with no timely response
Beneficiary inactive	Beneficiary management service	Beneficiary status is inactive or blocked
Fraud rule triggered	Fraud/risk engine	Risk rule or score caused rejection

Possible Cause	Where to Investigate	Evidence
Core banking unavailable	Core banking system	CBS unavailable or debit request failed
UPI switch unavailable	UPI switch / payment gateway	Switch unavailable or timed out

Finance Expert's Investigation Priority

When a transaction fails with only a generic message, a payments operations team would typically investigate in this order:

1. Check the transaction status and error code.
2. Determine whether the failure occurred before or after account debit.
3. Validate customer-side checks (OTP, balance, daily limit, beneficiary status).
4. Review fraud/risk engine decisions.
5. Verify core banking availability and debit processing.
6. Check the payment switch (UPI/IMPS/NEFT/RTGS) response.
7. Confirm the destination bank's response.
8. Correlate application logs, middleware logs, and monitoring events using the transaction ID.

This structured approach helps isolate the exact point of failure instead of relying on the generic customer-facing message.